

portable devices is relatively a recent technology. In this chapter we will present a brief history of journey of the iOS operating system that now forms the crux of the iPhone and iPad. We will also provide a brief overview of Apple's design culture and guiding philosophy that is instrumental in making iOS the way it is. What led to the development of the iOS 7 and why exactly was the update needed, is the fundamental question we will tackle in this feature.

iOS was revealed to the world by Steve Jobs in 2007 in the historic iPhone keynote presentation. An interesting piece of trivia is that iOS wasn't always known as iOS but instead started off as being called the iPhone OS, only changing to the shortened and simplistic "iOS" after the release of iOS 4 in 2010. When the operating system first started out it was not so laden with features. In fact there were some glaring omissions – the most famous was copy-paste. Feature to feature comparisons to Symbian and Blackberry were often made in those days and it wasn't guaranteed iOS would come out victorious each time. There was no support for third party applications, no multitasking features, and no options to customise home screen. Despite the obvious limitations, iOS did had some new and nifty features that paved the way for the development of iOS down the line. Apple popularised the concept of the capacitive touch screen and dared to be different. The capacitive touch screen elevated the user experience and enabled iOS to allow for some great features like pinch to zoom and inertial scrolling. Great touch screen response was the key during those days. Other innovations included the software keyboard, wide screen "iPod" and the Springboard homescreen that is now an iOS constant. Apple also took a gamble when it hid the phone

file system from the user establishing different layers of abstraction and disallowing users from performing simple tasks like making email attachments.

While being a hotly debated topic, this change in a smart-phone traditional fea-



Steve Jobs at the iPhone launch